

1. I know Kung-fu

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Sat, 20 Jun 2026 03:17:05 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/i-know-kung-fu>

Remember that scene in the Matrix where Neo is strapped into the chair and Link uploads all sorts of martial arts into his mind? When Neo wakes up, he says "I know Kung-fu," then proceeds to demonstrate his skill in a battle with Morpheus. That was a pretty amazing scene. But if you suspend your disbelief for a second, it also suggests that when you have all the information at your fingertips, knowledge is just a matter of uploading it into your mind. The directors of the movie conveniently skip the scene where we actually see him acquiring the knowledge. All we see is Link typing on the keyboard and different karate poses appearing on the screen. Is Neo practicing kicks? Is he doing strength training? Is he running up and down a mountain, carrying buckets of water a la Kill Bill? We don't know. So we have to assume that, from his seat, the information is simply being downloaded into his mind. What if we had this same capability in the real world? What if you had all the information you needed to learn any skill? You don't have to limit it to learning Kung-fu, but you sure can. What if I provided you with a computer, an internet connection, and a subscription to ChatGPT Pro Max UL...

2. datasette-apps 0.1a3

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-15T20:25:07+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/15/datasette-apps-2/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-apps 0.1a3 Fixed a bug where users without the create-app permission could still create apps. #27 Fixed a bug where it was impossible to grant permission to edit an app to users who were not the app's owner. The rules for edit/delete are now the same as view: if the app is private only the owner can modify it, otherwise permission is controlled by Datasette's regular permission system. #29 Tags: datasette

3. datasette-apps 0.1a2

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-15T17:26:11+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/15/datasette-apps/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette-apps 0.1a2 Custom network/CSP origins for apps are now guarded by a new apps-set-csp permission, with an optional allowed_csp_origins plugin allow-list for non-privileged users. The Datasette Agent app creation tool enforces the same rules. #24 Stored query picker now supports keyboard navigation and shows the three most recent accessible stored queries when focused. #fragment links inside apps are no longer intercepted by the external-link confirmation modal. #23 Fixed link confirmation modal and logging panels in ?full=1 full-screen mode. #26 Tags: datasette

4. Quoting Julia Evans

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-15T02:05:19+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/15/julia-evans/#atom-everything>

[...] Instead, I picture a specific person and I just write for them. Often this person is "me, but 3 years ago" or a good friend. ? Julia Evans , write for 1 person Tags: writing , julia-evans

5. What does it mean when the bottom bit of my HMODULE is set?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260619-00/?p=112447>

A special kind of HMODULE . The post What does it mean when the bottom bit of my HMODULE is set? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. Fox to Buy Roku Streaming Service in \$25 Billion Deal

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-19T18:29:40Z

Link: https://www.wsj.com/business/deals/fox-roku-deal-f6e564f9?st=mKdQwC&reflink=desktopwebshare_permalink

The Wall Street Journal on Monday: Fox Corp. said it is acquiring Roku in a deal valued at around \$25 billion, making a major bet on the future of ad-supported streaming. The deal ? Fox?s largest to date ? brings together a media company known for its live news and sports programming with the biggest provider of streaming platforms for connected TVs. It will add scale to Fox?s streaming business, currently home to free, ad-supported streaming service Tubi, which the company bought for \$400 million in 2020, and subscription-based Fox One and Fox Nation. In addition to distributing other streaming services through connected TVs and devices, Roku has its own ad-supported Roku Channel. The combined company will better compete with the likes of Amazon.com and Netflix for ad dollars. I?m late to comment on this, but this seems stupid. Roku sucks. I know they?ve got a 25 percent or so share of the smart TV interface market, but no one is attached to Roku. The entirety of their market share is people who don?t care. That?s not worth \$25 billion. Shit platforms seldom last, and the ones that do last achieve monopolies. I think Roku?s share is going to slip, not grow. ?

7. Snap Launches Ad Campaign for Specs Starring Michael Caine

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-19T16:32:14Z

Link: https://www.reddit.com/r/funny/comments/1jk6onr/bloody_large_glasses_by_michael_caine/
?They?re about power, aren?t they, and the bloody powerful blokes who wear them.? Maybe I?m all wet and these things are stylish, no matter what they do to your ears . ?

8. Jerry Seinfeld Tries Out Snap?s Specs

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-19T16:19:58Z

Link: <https://youtu.be/siM8NW24QPs?t=217>

?Hey buddy, nice frames.? Seinfeld?s father tried them out too . ?

9. All pieces on a 6 by 5 board

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Sat, 20 Jun 2026 21:41:16 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/20/z3-python-claude/>

I?ve written a couple posts lately on getting an LLM to generate code to solve chess problems. The first used Claude to generate Prolog and the second used ChatGPT to generate Prolog. This post will use Claude to generate Z3/Python code. The puzzle is one I?ve written about before: Place all the pieces?king, queen, two [?] The post All pieces on a 6 by 5 board first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Limiting web server bandwidth the brute force way

Source: Chris?s Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-06-20T03:00:50Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/web/ServerBruteForceBandwidthLimit>

A while back on the Fediverse, I mentioned something about our departmental web server : Wow, people do some extremely slow downloads from work?s main web server. We roll logs at midnight and Apache wrote the last log record to the old file at 03:58 (for a request that had started at 23:27). (For our sins we?ve become a load-bearing source of ML image training data, for the "CIFAR" image dataset. We average 40 Mbytes/sec outgoing web server bandwidth most days.) (This also got mentioned in passing in my entry on 24 hours of that server?s logs . I call us 'load-bearing' not only because of how popular this dataset is but also because in the past the department has gotten plaintive emails from people about it when the dataset wasn?t accessible.) Recently, so many requests started arriving that they overwhelmed our main departmental web server and we decided to deal with the problem by moving this data to another physical machine with its own, dedicated web server (and then using HTTP redirections to push 'people', which is to say software, to fetch the data from that new web server). (As is so often the case at universities, this isn?t an officially published dataset that had been g...

11. Glassblowing #3: A better thermionic diode

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Sat, 20 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/projects/glass/3/>

My last attempt at a vacuum tube technically worked, but not very well because there was a lot of glass between the anode and cathode: Because of this, many any electrons that miss anode and build up on the glass. This negative charge will keep accumulating until it's strong enough to overpower the anode's positive charge. With enough voltage, some current does flow, but a diode that only conducts a microamp at 1000 V is not very useful. On paper, the solution is simple: surround the filament in anode. This shields it against the influence of any accumulated charge and allows continuous current flow: In practice, building something something like this is tricky . There are the three wires that must be precicly aligned while being sealed through hot glass. For my tube, I started by attaching the leads to a chunk of scrap glass which keeps them aligned throughout the process: The internals can be attached on one side of the glass, and the other side can be sealed in an envelope without any risk of the tube falling apart. My filament is ~2 cm of 12 ?m tungsten wire, wrapped around hooks made from the lead-in wires. The anode is a square of copper foil, which I bent into a tube and we...

12. Which Copyleft Licence is Suitable for an SVG?

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Sat, 20 Jun 2026 11:34:22 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/06/which-copyleft-licence-is-suitable-for-an-svg/>

The Scalable Vector Graphics (SVG) format is amazing. It allows you to precisely define how an image should look. Written in XML, it uses various mathematical operations to display an image which looks crisp and clear at any size. Here's a trivial example: ?

13. This Week in Package Management: 20 June 2026

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-06-20T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/06/20/this-week-in-package-management.html>

Week five of the roundup, built from the package manager OPML feed collection and whatever I've posted or boosted on Mastodon . Releases sbt 2.0.0 moves build definitions and plugins to Scala 3, requires JDK 17, and replaces the caching layer with a Bazel-compatible local/remote cache that the rewritten compile and test tasks use. The project matrix plugin is now built in and a native-image client cuts startup time. sbt 1.12.12 shipped alongside it for the 1.x line. pnpm 11.7 adds a frozenStore setting that opens the store's SQLite index read-only so pnpm install can run against a Nix store, a read-only bind mount or an OCI layer without trying to write WAL sidecar files. The release also adds a --batch flag to publish a whole workspace in one request, per-scope auth tokens, and an option to delegate resolving installs to pacquet. pnpm 10.34.4 on the v10 line fixes two path-traversal issues. A traversal-shaped configDependencies name or version in pnpm-workspace.yaml could write files outside node_modules/.pnpm-config and the store (GHSA-qrv3-253h-g69c), and a crafted lockfile alias under nodeLinker: hoisted could write outside the install root (GHSA-fr4h-3cph-29xv , also fixed...

14. Reading List 06/20/26

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Sat, 20 Jun 2026 12:01:56 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/reading-list-062026>

A new housing bill, General Motors joining the grid-scale battery game, skepticism about data center delays, solid-state air conditioning, and more.

15. Pluralistic: How the Epstein Class recruits (20 Jun 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Sat, 20 Jun 2026 16:12:26 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/06/20/any-club-that-would-have-me/>

Today's links How the Epstein Class recruits: Oh wait, THAT'S what this was?! Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: MPAA blasted in WSJ; RFID skimmers; Post-Soviet inventions; "Farthing"; "Dirty, Drunk and Punk"; Dweb v founders' frailty; Tax cheating made simple; Oregon v corporate medicine. Upcoming appearances: Toronto, NYC, Philadelphia, Chicago, London, Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where

I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. How the Epstein Class recruits (permalink) Perhaps you've encountered the stories about Dialog, an extremely weird secret society associated with Peter "Antichrist" Thiel, whose membership data and details have leaked this week:

<https://www.wired.com/story/how-peter-thiels-private-dialog-club-secretly-ranks-its-members/> By all appearances, this is a comically creepy, awful talking-shop for the Epstein Class. It's not all that surprising, in retrospect, to learn that all these terrible people were in a group chat, secretly assigning ratings to one another, and periodically gather...